

Lab 2: Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

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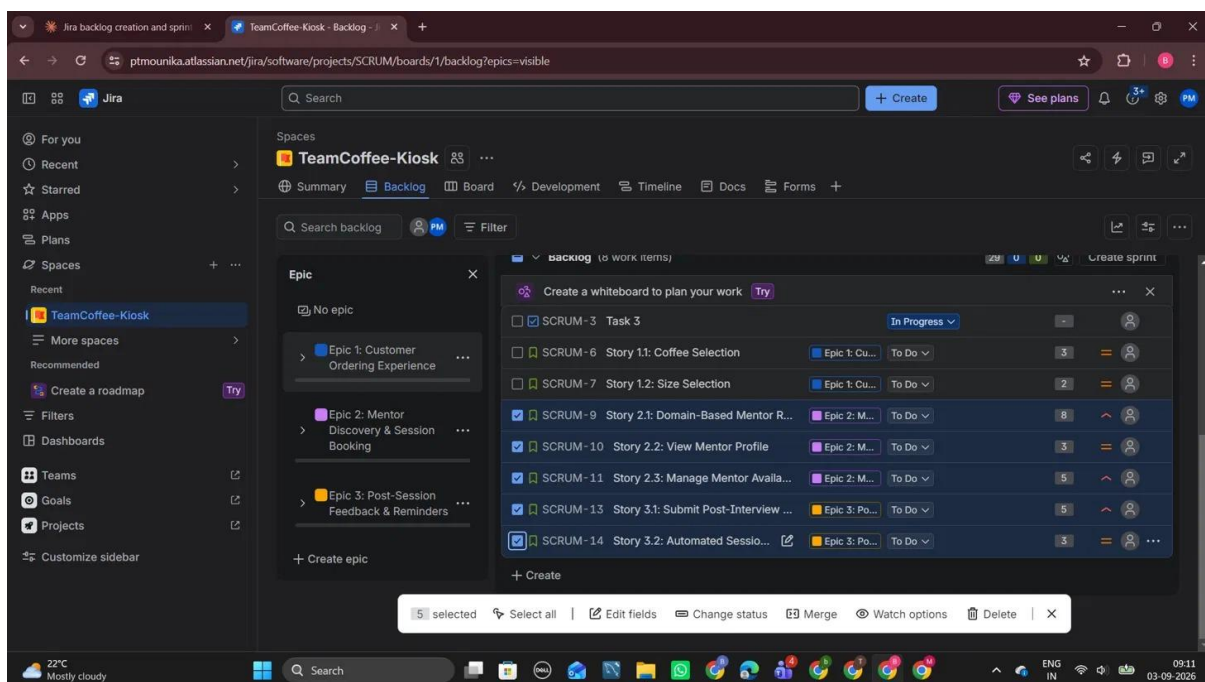
Section : 5F

Project Overview

A Scrum project ("TeamCoffee-Kiosk") was created in Jira to convert the Lab 1 functional requirements for the Alumni Mentorship & Mock Interview Platform into an Agile backlog. The backlog was organized into Epics and User Stories, prioritized, estimated using story points, and used to simulate two sprints to analyze team progress using Jira's built-in Sprint Board and Burndown Chart tools.

Epics and User Stories

The Lab 1 functional requirements (FR-001 to FR-005) were grouped into two Epics, broken down into five User Stories using the "As a / I want / So that" format, and prioritized based on business value.



Epic 2: Mentor Discovery & Session Booking

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Story	User Story	Priority	Points	Sprint
2.1 Domain-Based Mentor Recommendation	As a student mentee, I want the system to recommend alumni mentors based on domain matching, so that I can find mentors relevant to my interests and book a session with one click	High	8	Sprint 1
2.2 View Mentor Profile	As a student mentee, I want to view an alumni mentor's profile including domain expertise, company, and past mentee ratings, so that I can make an informed choice before booking	Medium	3	Sprint 1
2.3 Manage Mentor Availability	As an alumni mentor, I want to set and update my weekly availability slots, so that students only see accurate, bookable time slots and scheduling conflicts are avoided	High	5	Sprint 1

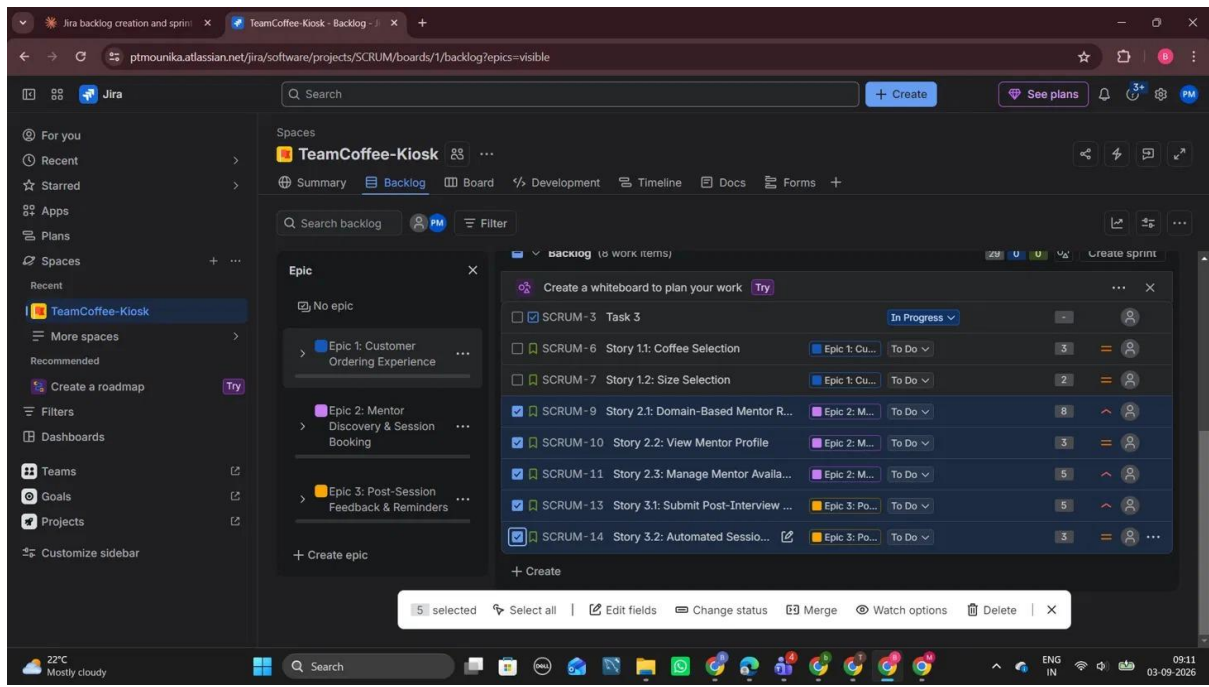
Epic 3: Post-Session Feedback & Reminders

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Story	User Story	Priority	Points	Sprint
3.1 Submit Post-Interview Scorecard	As an alumni mentor, I want to submit a structured post-interview scorecard for each mentee session, so that student progress is tracked and feedback is properly recorded	High	5	Sprint 1
3.2 Automated Session Reminders	As a student mentee or alumni mentor, I want to receive automated reminders 24 hours and 1 hour before a scheduled session, so that I don't miss my mentorship session	Medium	3	Sprint 2

Story Point Estimation

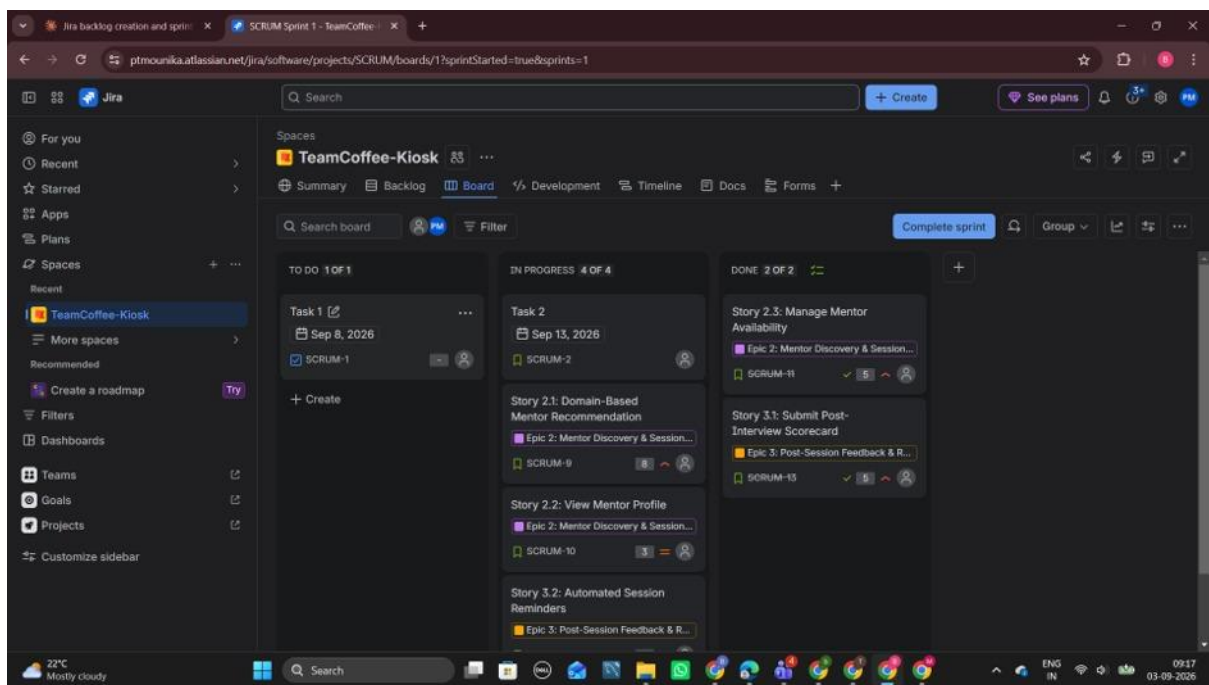
The screenshot displays the Jira TeamCoffee-Kiosk backlog. The interface shows a sidebar with navigation options like 'For you', 'Recent', 'Starred', 'Apps', 'Plans', 'Spaces', 'Teams', 'Goals', and 'Projects'. The main area shows the 'TeamCoffee-Kiosk' space with a 'Backlog' view. The backlog is organized into sprints and epics. The 'SCRUM Sprint 0' (3 Sep - 17 Sep) contains two tasks: 'SCRUM-1 Task 1' (To Do, Sep 8) and 'SCRUM-2 Task 2' (In Progress, Sep 13). The 'SCRUM Sprint 1' (Add dates, 2 work items) contains two stories: 'SCRUM-9 Story 2.1: Domain-B...' (In Progress, 8 points) and 'SCRUM-6 Story 1.1: Coffee Sel...' (To Do, 3 points). The 'Backlog' (1 work item) contains 'SCRUM-3 Task 3' (In Progress). The bottom of the screen shows a Windows taskbar with the date 03-09-2026 and time 09:30.



Story point assignments visible in the Jira backlog (Fibonacci scale).

Each User Story was estimated using the Fibonacci sequence (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13...) based on complexity, effort, and uncertainty, simulating a Planning Poker exercise where team members would independently estimate and discuss story difficulty.

Sprint 1 – Active Sprint Board

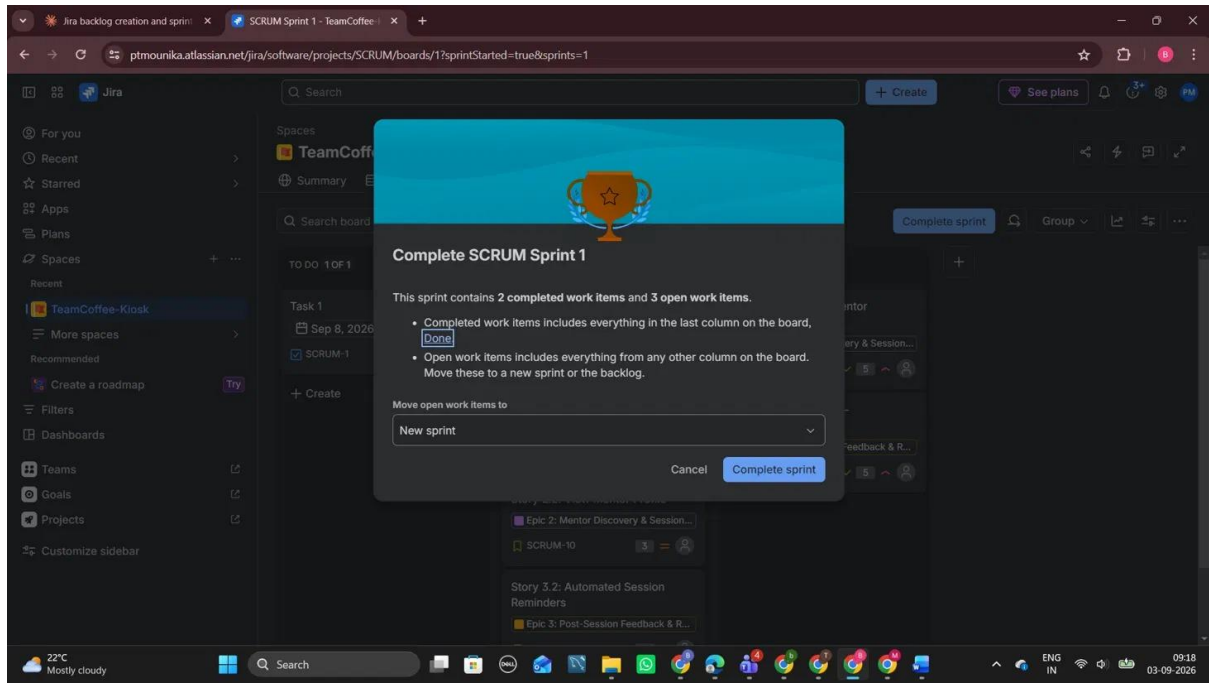


Sprint 1 Active Sprint Board showing task progress across To Do, In Progress, and Done.

Sprint 1 was created with 5 backlog items totaling 24 story points, drawn from Epic 2 (Mentor Discovery & Session Booking) and Epic 3 (Post-Session Feedback & Reminders).

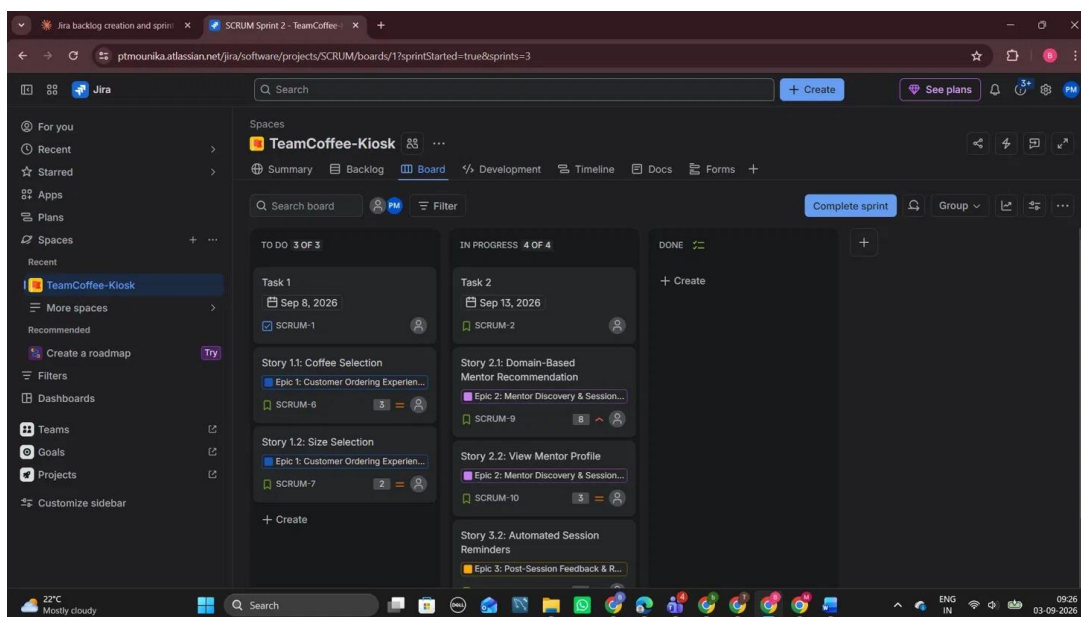
Task progress was simulated by moving items across the board columns: To Do → In Progress → Done.

Sprint 1 – Completion Summary



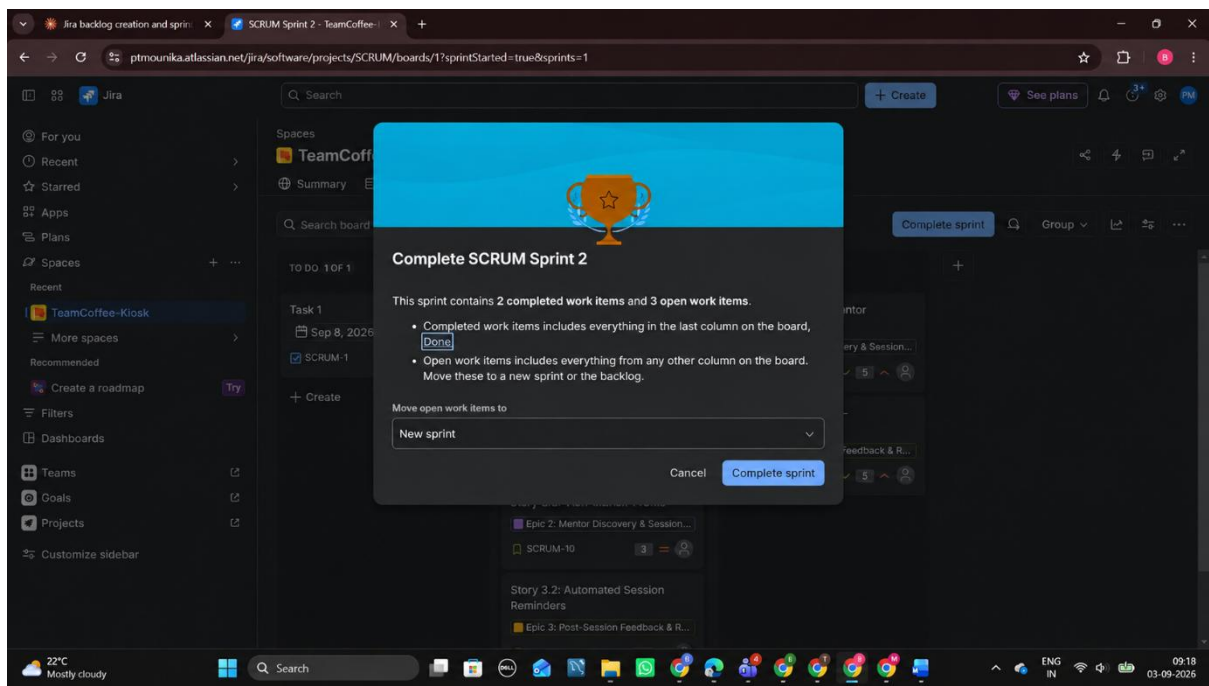
Sprint 1 was completed after simulating task progress across the board. Of the 5 items in the sprint, 2 were marked Done (Story 2.3: Manage Mentor Availability, Story 3.1: Submit Post-Interview Scorecard), while the remaining 3 open items were automatically rolled over into Sprint 2, as is standard Agile practice for incomplete work.

Sprint 2 – Active Sprint Board



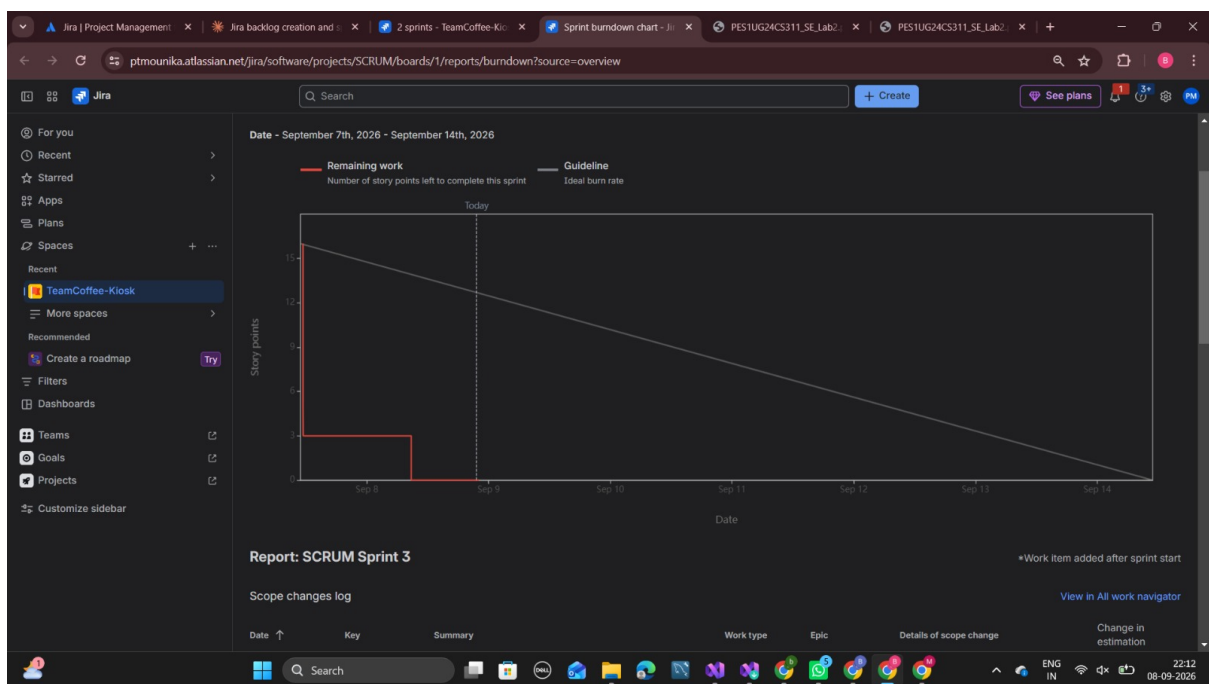
Sprint 2 Active Sprint Board showing task progress for the second sprint cycle.

Sprint 2 – Completion Summary



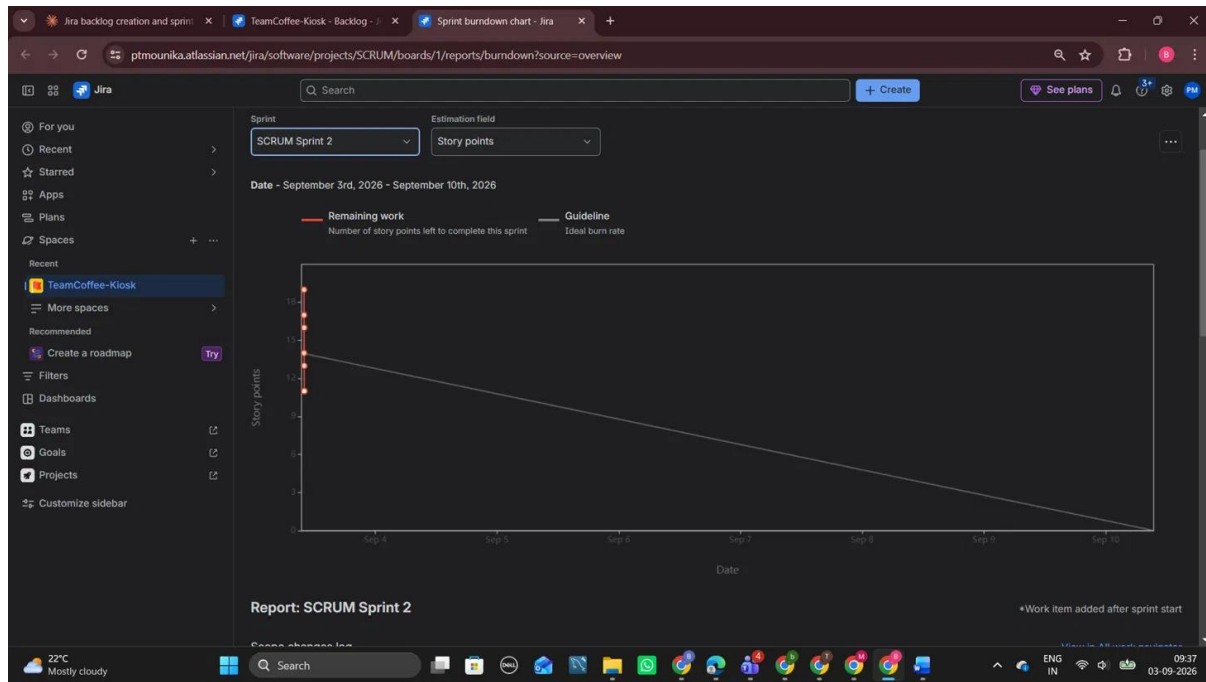
Sprint 2 was completed after simulating task progress across the board. Of the 5 items in the sprint, 3 were marked Done, while 2 items remained in progress/to-do at the time of completion. This marks the successful completion of two full sprint cycles as required by the lab exercise.

Burndown Chart – Sprint 1



The burndown chart for Sprint 1 tracks the number of story points remaining against the ideal guideline (grey line) over the sprint duration. Since Sprint 1 was simulated and completed within a short time frame rather than over a full week, the chart shows a sharp vertical drop rather than a gradual decline, reflecting the rapid completion of the simulation rather than a realistic team velocity.

Burndown Chart – Sprint 2



Reflection Questions

1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Since this exercise was a simulated sprint rather than one carried out over a full working week, it is difficult to compare estimated story points against genuine development effort in the traditional sense. However, the relative sizing between stories was reasoned out carefully before assigning points. Stories that involved more complex logic, such as Story 2.1: Domain-Based Mentor Recommendation, which requires matching algorithms across multiple domains and one-click booking integration, were assigned a higher value of 8 points. In contrast, simpler stories such as Story 2.2: View Mentor Profile, which mainly involves displaying existing data on a page, were assigned a lower value of 3 points. This relative comparison approach mirrors how Planning Poker is meant to function in practice, where the team is not estimating in absolute hours but in relative units of complexity, effort, and risk. In a real, non-simulated sprint, the accuracy of these estimations would only become clear after actual development work was completed and could be compared against the story point values. In future sprints, this comparison would help refine and calibrate the team's estimation accuracy over time, which is one of the key long-term benefits of using story points and the Fibonacci scale consistently.

2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes, the backlog was intentionally structured to reflect the priorities established in the original Lab 1 requirements table. Functional requirements that were marked as High priority in that table, specifically FR-001, FR-002, and FR-004, were carried forward and reflected as High priority in their corresponding user stories in Jira, namely Story 2.1, Story 2.3, and Story 3.1. Similarly, requirements marked as Medium priority, FR-003 and FR-005, were reflected as Medium priority in Story 2.2 and Story 3.2. This ensured that the most business-critical functionality, such as mentor recommendation and mentor availability management, would be tackled earlier in the sprint sequence rather than being left until later. Prioritizing in this way also aligns with Agile best practices, which emphasize delivering the highest-value features first so that stakeholders can see meaningful progress early and provide feedback sooner. Keeping this alignment between the original requirements table and the Jira backlog also made it easier to trace each user story back to its original functional requirement, which is valuable for both project tracking and future audits of the requirements coverage.

3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

The simulated sprints followed the original plan reasonably closely, though with some natural adjustments that are common even in real Agile teams. Sprint 1 was planned with five backlog items totaling twenty-four story points, primarily focused on Epic 2: Mentor Discovery & Session Booking and Epic 3: Post-Session Feedback & Reminders. During the simulation, two of these five items were successfully moved all the way to Done, while the remaining three were still in progress at the point the sprint was closed. This is a realistic and expected outcome, since not every sprint results in one hundred percent completion, and Agile methodology explicitly accounts for this through the practice of rolling incomplete work into the next sprint rather than treating it as a failure. These three unfinished items were carried over into Sprint 2 along with two additional stories from Epic 1, and by the end of Sprint 2, three of the five items in that sprint were marked Done. Overall, the simulation demonstrated the intended sprint workflow accurately: items moving through To Do, In Progress, and Done, incomplete work being carried forward, and the team continuing to make steady progress across both sprint cycles, even though the actual time spent moving cards was compressed for the purposes of this lab.

4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown charts for both sprints provided a useful, if simplified, visualization of how work was progressing relative to the ideal guideline. Because both sprints were simulated and completed within a very short time frame rather than over a full one-week duration, the resulting burndown lines appeared as sharp, near-vertical drops rather than the smoother, more gradual declines that would typically be seen in a real sprint spread across several working days. This is an important insight in itself: burndown charts are highly sensitive to the pace at which work is actually logged as complete, and a chart showing a steep drop close to the start of a sprint would, in a real team setting, either indicate that the team is finishing work unusually quickly, or, more likely in this case, that the timestamps do not reflect genuine day-by-day effort. In a real-world scenario, if the actual remaining-work line consistently sits below the guideline line, it suggests the team may be under-committing to work during sprint planning and could safely take on more in future sprints. Conversely, if the line consistently sits above the guideline, it would suggest the team has over-committed and should scale back the amount of work planned for each sprint. For this simulation specifically, the chart primarily demonstrated the

mechanics of how Jira calculates and visualizes burndown data, and how scope changes, such as items being added after a sprint starts, are also reflected transparently on the chart. This reinforces why burndown charts are considered a valuable, ongoing communication tool for Agile teams, rather than something to be checked only at the end of a sprint.
